Chinese emperor for the Indian monk Buddhabada, who taught a form of Theravada Buddhism. He became its first abbot and among his first disciples were several exponents of the Chinese martial art of *Shuai Jiao*, which had already been in existence for several centuries. So when Bodhidharma came to Shaolin in or about 527 a martial arts tradition was already well established, with his first disciple, Huike, being a known exponent. The first known manual of *wushu*, better known as kung fu, was written by a visitor to Shaolin in about 1610 and makes no mention of Bodhidharma as the originator of the art.[14]

Much of the success of Mahayana Buddhism came from its promotion of Bodhisattvas as interceders on behalf of mankind. Of these Bodhisattvas by far and away the most popular was Avalokiteshvara, 'the lord who looks down on the caller', who helped to make Buddhism accessible to the masses, in part by taking on some of the traits of the Vedic demi-god Purusha along with elements of Shiva, Vishnu, Indra and Surya. The earliest written text in which Avalokiteshvara appears is the famous *Lotus Sutra*, versions of which had reached China by the third century CE. There is a strong case for locating Avalokiteshvara's origins in second-century Nagarjunakonda as a product of Madyamaka teaching. From there he went on to occupy a place within Mahayana Buddhism second only to the Buddha himself. In Tibet he became Chenresig, the protector of Tibet, with the Dalai Lamas as his manifestation; in China he changed sex to become Guanyin, 'goddess of mercy', and Guazon or Cannon in Japan; and in Lanka he came to be worshipped at Natha, with Taradevi as his *shakti*.[15]

The accounts of the travels of the Chinese monk Xuanzang, who visited practically every major Buddhist community in India between 630 and 645 CE, show that in most of these places Mahayana and Theravada schools co-existed side by side with other lesser schools of Buddhism.